ACOL · WEAK NT (12-14) - BIDDING FLOWCHART

Updated 2 Nov 2026

Letters A-H link each opening bid to its response flowchart. Points are HCP. Alertable: transfers, McKendrick 2♠, Jacoby 2NT, weak twos, Ogust, 2♣, Helvic.

OPENING BIDS

1NT 12-14 balanced → **A**

1♣/♦/♥/♠ longest suit. Equal 4-4: ♥ > ♠ > ♦ > ♣ · **5-5: the higher-ranking**. Balanced 15-19 → **C** · unbalanced 13-22, or 11-12 when HCP + two longest suits ≥ 20 → **B, D**

2NT 20-22 balanced → **E**

2♣ 23+ any shape, game forcing → **E**

2♦/♥/♠ weak two: 5-10 HCP, 6-card suit → **E**

3-level / 4-level pre-empts: 7-card / 8-card suit, 0-9 HCP → **H**

Opponents bid (overcall or double) → **F, H**

Slam: 4NT once a suit is agreed, loser count → **G**

A RESPONSES TO 1NT (12-14)

BALANCED, no 5-card major (and no 4-card major with 11+)

0-10
Pass

11
2♠ McKendrick

12
2NT invite

13-18
3NT

19-20 4NT quant.
21+ 6NT

2♠ = 11-pt range-ask, or a weak long minor (0-10, 6+ cards). Opener 2NT = 12-13: 11 pass · weak hand 3♣/3♦ to play. Opener 3♣ = 14: 11 bids 3NT · weak clubs pass · weak diamonds 3♦.

Opener: 12 pass · 13-14 3NT

Opener: 14 → 6NT, else pass

A 5-card major, or a 4-card major with 11+

2♦ → 2♥ · 2♥ → 2♠ TRANSFERS: 5+ major, any strength (5-5: spades). Opener always completes.

Then: 0-10 pass · **11**: five → 2NT (opener: with 3 trumps 12 → 3M, 13-14 → 4M; with 2, 12 pass, 13-14 3NT) · six → 3M (13-14 → 4M) · **12+ or ≤6 losers**: five → 3NT (opener 4M with 3) · six → 4M.

2♣ STAYMAN: 11+ with a 4-card major, or weak 5-4 majors (0-10). Opener: **2♦** no major · **2♥** 4♥ (may hold 4♠) · **2♠** 4♠, ≤3♥.

Fit: 11-12 3M invite (13-14 accept) · 13+ or ≤6 losers 4M. **No fit:** 11-12 2NT · 13+ 3NT. After 2♥ with 4♠: 2NT / 3NT (opener with 4♠: 3♠/4♠ over 2NT, 4♠ over 3NT). **Weak 5-4:** pass a fit; over 2♦ the 5-card major to play (≤6 losers: 3M forcing / 4M).

Long minors: 6+ and 0-10 → 2♠ then 3♣/3♦ · 12-15 → 3NT · 16+ → 5m. **Shape:** opposite 12-14 (about 8 losers) a long major with ≤6 losers is worth game. **Natural option** (switch in the trainer): 2♦/2♥ to play, weak spades via Stayman, 3M = five 12+, 4M = six.

B RESPONSES TO 1♣/♦/♥/♠

4+ card support for a major

2M 6-9 · **3M** 10-12 · **4M** shape raise (7 losers, under 13 HCP) · **2NT JACOBY** 13+, or 10+ with ≤6 losers (game forcing). **Losers** (with a singleton, void or 5 trumps): 9 → 2M · 8 → 3M · 7 → 4M. 0-5 with ≤9 losers: 2M. *Natural option: 2NT 10-12, 4M 13-15, 16+ new suit then support.*

After 2M: 19+ or ≤5 losers 4M · 16-18 or 6 losers 3M try (responder 8-9 or ≤8 losers → 4M) · else pass. 4NT if losers say 12 tricks (G).

After 3M: 14+ or ≤6 losers 4M, else pass. **After 4M:** slam check (G).

After Jacoby: short suit → 3 of it · else 4M 13-14 · 3NT 15-17 · 3M 18+. Responder: 4M, or 4NT when slam is there (G).

Other responses

New suit: longest; 4-4 the lower (4-4 majors: ♥), **5-5 the higher**. 1-level 6+ (fewer with shape: 4-5 with ≤9 losers, or a 5+ suit with ≤7 losers) · 2-level 9+ (with less, 1NT: it keeps the auction low). 6-5 with a longer minor: the minor first. Forcing. **Never skip a 4-card major** over 1♣/♦ (unless a longer minor and 10+); over 1♠ with 4♥ and 10+: 2♥.

Minor raise (4+, no 4-card major): 2m 6-9 · 3m 10-12. **1NT** 6-9 · **2NT** 10-12 bal (over 1♥/♠: a new suit, then 2NT) · **3NT** 13-15 bal.

Opener: after 2m: 16-18 no short suit 2NT (8-9 → 3NT) · 19 3NT · short suit 3m try (8-9 → 3NT). After 3m: 14+ 3NT · **short suit** + 14+ or ≤6 losers: show a stopper, 3x (responder 3NT with the other suits stopped, else 4m; opener 5m with ≤5 losers). **After 2NT (over 1m):** six in a major 4M · 2nd 5-card suit 3x (forcing) · five in a major + 14 3M (3 → 4M) · 14+ 3NT · 13: pass (6-card minor 3m). **After 3NT:** six-card major, unbalanced: 4M.

C NT REBIDS (bal 15-19)

Balanced 15-19 opens a suit and rebids no-trumps (with 4 of partner's major, raise it instead).

After a 1-level reply: 15-16 1NT · 17-18 2NT · 19 3NT.

After a 2-level reply: 15-16 2NT · 17-19 3NT.

Responder after 1NT: ≤8 pass · 9 2NT (opener 16 → 3NT) · 10+ game · six in a major: 2M weak, 4M with 9+ or ≤7 losers · **five in a major + game values: 3M forcing** (opener 4M with 3, else 3NT). **After 2NT:** 8+ game (five in a major: 3M). **After 3NT:** pass, 4M with six; 14+ 6NT.

D OPENER'S SUIT REBIDS (13-22)

13-14 "weak": raise partner's suit with 4 · **never skip a 4-card major** (after a 2-level reply 2♥/2♠ is fine with 13-14) · new suit below the barrier · rebid a 5+ suit. **After a 2-level reply a new suit is forcing**: don't jump with 15-18.

15-18 "strong": 5-5 / 6-5: show the 2nd suit, even as a reverse (also 13-14 with ≤5 losers; ≤4 losers: jump) · double raise · jump rebid of a 6+ suit · reverse with a 4-card suit.

19-22: jump shift, game forcing (after a 2-level reply a 3-level new suit is enough: never jump past 3NT) · 4 trumps for partner: game.

Responder after a minimum: ≤10 pass or preference · 11-12 invite · 13+ game. **After your 2-level reply opener's new suit forces:** raise with 4 · preference with 3 · else rebid 6 / 2NT. **No fit:** 2NT/3NT only with the unbid suits stopped and no singleton in partner's suit; otherwise a second 4+ suit at the 3-level, forcing (opener: 3NT with a stopper · rebid six · support · responder then picks the game). **Own 6-card suit, no fit:** rebid it (11-12 jump; 13+ game). Weak minor over a minor rebid: pass with a doubleton. **Unbid 4-card major, 10+:** bid it at the 2-level (forcing; opener raises with 4, shows 3 in your 1st major, else 2NT). After a 1NT reply, a 6+ unbid suit: bid it to play.

After a reverse: 10+ game · 6-9: raise the 2nd suit with 4, else preference; opener bids game with 17+ or ≤5 losers (6-5 with ≤4 losers: always). **After a jump rebid:** 10+ game · six in a major (8+): 3M forcing (opener 4M with 2). **After a jump shift:** never pass: support (slam check, G) · six in a major: 3M · minor fit + short suit: 5m · else 3NT. **Opener raises your minor:** 12+ 3NT. **Double raise:** 10+ game.

Barrier = 2 of the opening suit; a new suit above it is a reverse (15+). With a fit, losers decide game: 24 − (yours + partner's) ≥ 10 for a major, 11 for a minor (G).

E 2NT · 2♣ · WEAK TWOS (OGUST)

2NT 20-22 bal: 0-3 pass · 4+: 3NT · 3♣ Stayman (opener 3♦/3♥/3♠; then 4M with a fit, else 3NT) · 3♥/3♠ five (opener 4M with 3, else 3NT) · 4♥/4♠ six.

2♣ 23+: 2♦ negative 0-7 · positive 8+: 4+ suit 2♥/♠, 5+ suit 3♣/♦, bal 8-9 2NT, 10-12 3NT. After 2♦: 2♥/♠ five (0-3 2NT; 4+ 4M with 3, else 3NT) · 3♣/♦ (show a 5+ major: opener 4M with 3, else 3NT) · 23-24 2NT · 25+ 3NT.

Weak two 2♦/♥/♠ (5-10, 6-card suit). Responder: pass (under 14) · 3M with 3 trumps · 4M with 4+ (and with 4+ and 14+: game, no need to ask) · **2NT ask 14+** · own good 6+ major, ≤2 in partner's suit, 14+ or ≤5 losers: 4 of your suit · void in partner's suit: don't ask. **OGUST** answers: 3♣ min poor · 3♦ min good · 3♥ max poor · 3♠ max good · 3NT AKQ (good = 2 of the top 3). Then sign off at 3M, or bid game (3NT if a minor). **Features option** (switch): 3M minimum · outside A/K = maximum.

F OVERCALLS AND DOUBLES

Overcalls (their 1-suit opening): 1-level 5+ good suit, 8+ · 2-level 6+ good suit, 10+ · **jump 6+ suit, 13-16** (strong) · 1NT 16-18 balanced with a stopper.

Takeout double: 12+, 3+ in every unbid suit. Advancer: **a 4-card major first**, else longest suit · 0-8 cheapest · 9-11 jump · 12+ game. Don't pass unless opener's partner bids.

Partner overcalls: raise with 3+ (2+ after a jump overcall): 6-10 one level, 11-12 two, 13+ game · change suit only if yours is longer (6+) · NT only with a good stopper.

Partner opens, RHO overcalls or doubles: bid as you would have done (no negative doubles). The suit you would have bid is theirs: show your other suit, or NT with their suit stopped (6-9 1NT, 10-12 2NT, 13+ 3NT). A 5+ suit with ≤7 losers may bid at the 2-level under 9. Raise by losers as in B.

Lead partner's suit when defending.

G RKCB · LOSING TRICKS

RKCB 4NT once a trump suit is agreed (4NT straight over NT is quantitative). Key cards = 4 aces + the K of trumps. Replies: **5♣ 0 or 3 · 5♦ 1 or 4 · 5♥ 2 without Q · 5♠ 2 with Q**.

CONTROL BIDS after Jacoby (slam possible, 29+ or LTC 12, but a suit without A/K/shortness, or a void): cheapest **ace or void** below 4M; skipping a suit denies one. Partner: cheapest ace/void, else 4M. All controlled → 4NT; else 4M.

Asker: missing two key cards → 5 of trumps · missing one → 6 · all five and the trump Q → 5NT for kings (partner bids his cheapest side king, or 6 of trumps with none), then 7 with a side king. Trumps = the agreed suit (a new suit then support plays in opener's suit).

WHEN TO ASK: a fit and 31+ points between you, **or** the loser count says 12 tricks: 24 − (yours + partner's) ≥ 12. Use 4NT only when there is room to stop at 5 of the suit.

LOSING TRICK COUNT (8+ card fit only, never NT). **24 − (opener's losers + responder's losers) = tricks**: 10 → game in a major, 11 → game in a minor, 12 → slam. Losers overrule points only with real shape (singleton, void, 5+ trumps).

Opener		Responder	
Points	**Losers**	**Points**	**Losers**
12-14	7-8	0-5	10
15-17	6	6-9	9
18-19	5	10-11	8
20-22	4	12-15	7
23+	3	16+	6

H PRE-EMPTS · THEIR 1NT · OUR 1NT DOUBLED

Pre-empts (0-9): 3♣-3♠ 7-card suit · 4♣-4♠ 8-card suit. Partner: change suit only if yours is longer · with 3-4 top honours: 3m → 3NT, 3M → 4M, 4m → 5m.

Over their pre-empt (12+): 6-card suit at the 3-level (equal: the higher; a 6+ major with ≤5 losers: game) · 7-card suit at the 4-level · double = takeout. Partner: longest suit, game with 12+; raise to game with 12+ and 2-card support.

Their 12-14 1NT: double = 16+ penalty · 2-level overcall: 10+ with a good 6+ suit, or 8+ with a 7-card suit (or six with ≤6 losers).

Our 1NT doubled: 5+ suit sign-off 2♦/♥/♠, otherwise pass (opener passes the sign-off).

HELVIC WRIGGLE (option): pass = 9+ values (pass the forced XX) or a wriggle (after opener's XX bid 4-card suits up the line) · XX = weak one-suiter (opener 2♣, pass or correct) · 2♣/♦/♥ = that suit and the next one up.

Opening · Response · Opener rebid · Convention · Competitive · Note

Print on A3, or scale to fit A4. Arrows show the order of the auction.